FOLFIRI

Day 1: irinotecan, folinic acid and fluorouracil, then a 46-hour fluorouracil pump. A cycle lasts 14 days; your team confirms the next treatment.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hair

Irinotecan

Hair thinning or loss may occur. Ask about support.

2 Mouth

Fluorouracil + folinic acid

Report ulcers or pain affecting eating and drinking.

3 Chest

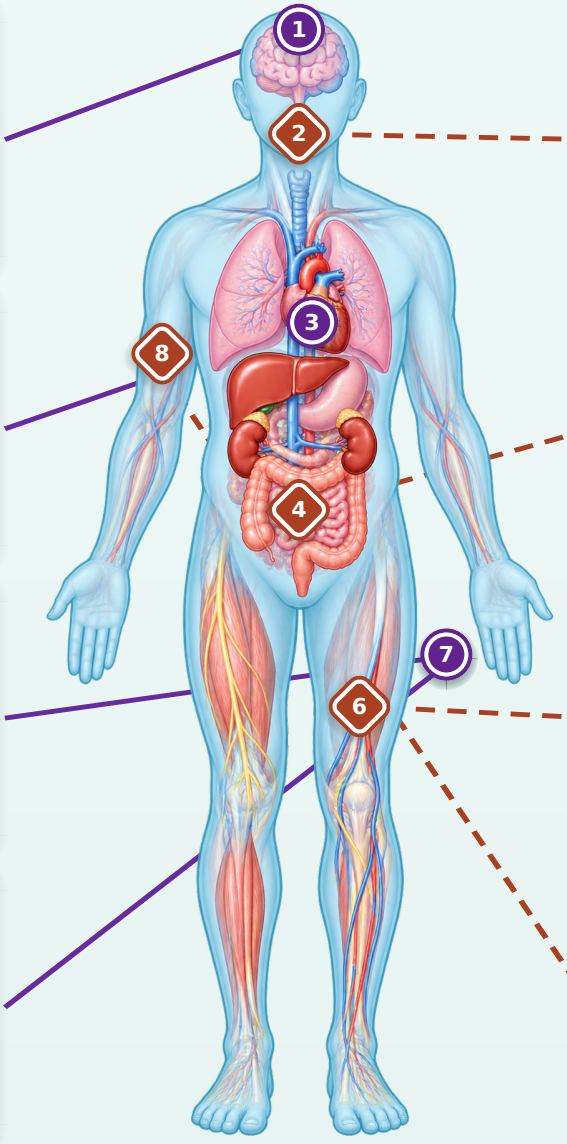
Fluorouracil

New chest pain or breathlessness needs urgent assessment.

4 Bowel

Irinotecan / fluorouracil

Report diarrhoea, increased stoma output or severe abdominal pain.



5 Hands / feet

Fluorouracil

Report painful redness, peeling or loss of hand function.

6 Blood / infection

Chemotherapy

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: call oncology immediately.

7 Skin / hands / feet

Fluorouracil

Report painful skin changes affecting activity.

8 Pump / line

Treatment delivery

Pain, leakage, swelling or poor wound healing needs advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Irinotecan

- Early cramps, sweating and diarrhoea
- Delayed diarrhoea and dehydration
- Low blood counts / serious infection
- Nausea, mouth soreness and fatigue
- Hair thinning or loss
- Rare serious lung or allergic reactions

Folinic acid

- Enhances fluorouracil activity and toxicity
- Rare allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea / mouth soreness in combination

Fluorouracil

- Diarrhoea, dehydration and mouth ulcers
- Low blood counts / infection
- Hand-foot skin soreness
- Cardiotoxicity including chest pain / ischaemia
- Severe early toxicity including DPD-related toxicity
- Pump / central-line complications

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Nausea prevention and rescue

Take the prescribed prevention medicines at the planned times and keep rescue treatment available. Tell the team if nausea or constipation is not controlled; do not duplicate steroid or anti-sickness medicines.

Bowel symptoms

Irinotecan can cause immediate cramps or sweating during the infusion and delayed diarrhoea afterwards. These need different treatments. Ask for the written rescue and urgent-contact plan before starting.

Counts and recovery

White-cell growth-factor injections are prescribed according to individual risk and previous complications. They are not automatically required for every patient or every cycle.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00227/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.